

Journal of Development Economics

Pre-Results Review (Registered Reports)

Stage 1 Submission Template

Contents

Instructions for this Template	2
Cover page (<i>required</i>)	3
Proposed timeline (<i>required</i>)	3
Abstract (<i>required</i>)	3
Reporting checklist for Stage 1 submissions (<i>optional</i>)	4
1. Introduction	1
Research question: background, importance and relevance	1
2. Research Design	1
Intervention(s)	1
Hypotheses	1
Basic methodological framework / Identification strategy	2
Data	2
Sample	2
Data collection and processing	2
Variations from the intended sample size	2
Pilot data	2
3. Empirical Analysis	3
Statistical methods	3
Statistical model	3
Multiple outcome and multiple hypothesis testing	3
Heterogeneous Effects	3

4. List of References	3
5. Appendices	3
6. Administrative information (<i>required</i>).....	3
Bibliography	5

Instructions for this Template

The following template is intended to assist you in the preparation of your Stage 1 Registered Report (RR) submission to the *Journal of Development Economics*.

Stage 1 RR submissions normally include a description of the key background literature and motivation for the study, hypotheses, study procedures, proposed statistical analysis plan, a statistical power analysis, and pilot data (wherever applicable). Beyond these, the following items are required for all Stage 1 RR submissions:

- *Cover Page*, including title of the study, date of the latest draft, keywords, JEL codes, and study pre-registration status;
- *Proposed timeline for completion of the study*, if accepted based on pre-results review;
- *Abstract* of up to 150 words;
- *Administrative Information* section (included at the end of the submission), including statements on funding, ethics approval, conflicts of interest and acknowledgments.

Please note that not all of the fields included in this template may be applicable to your research project. If so, please feel free to modify or delete sections accordingly.

The [JDE RR Author Guidelines](#) provide more information specific to the RR format, and the [JDE Author Information Pack](#) provides general information on the JDE's topical and methodological scope, impact factor, and rules for abstracting and indexing.

Please contact Aleksandar Bogdanoski (abogdanoski@berkeley.edu) with questions about study pre-registration, pre-analysis plans and how to submit your article. For editorial questions, please contact either Lead Editor Prof. Andrew Foster (andrew_foster@brown.edu) or Editor Prof. Dean Karlan (karlan@northwestern.edu).

Cover page (*required*)

Journal of Development Economics Registered Report Stage 1: Proposal **(Insert study title here)**

Date of latest draft: MM/DD/YYYY

Keywords: Provide up to six keywords in for indexing purposes.

JEL codes: Provide up to six codes from those available at the [JEL website](#).

Study pre-registration: Please provide the registry name, registration identifier, and/or a link to the public registration if available. If a pre-registration has not been completed, please indicate whether you plan to complete pre-registration before the commencement of data collection. See the 'Pre-registration Resources' section of the [JDE RR Author Guidelines](#) for a list of registries.

Proposed timeline (*required*)

If granted accepted based on pre-results review, please indicate when this study will be completed? The proposed timeline will not have an impact on the editorial decision at Stage 1. However, authors will be expected communicate any changes in the study timeline to the editorial board.

Abstract (*required*)

Please limit the abstract content to a maximum of 150 words. An abstract is often presented separately from the article, so it must be able to stand alone.

To the extent possible, please address the following questions in your abstract:

- What is/are the research question(s) of this study and why is it important for the development economics literature?
- What is the main outcome variable; what is/are the secondary outcome variable(s) (if any) and what is the intervention?
- What kind of methodological framework will the study use to address the research question?

Reporting checklist for Stage 1 submissions *(optional)*

Reporting checklist table with research design details available for download [here](#).

1. Introduction

Research question: background, importance and relevance

- What is the main problem/question motivating the study? Why is this question important for the field of development economics?
- How has this problem/question been addressed thus far in the relevant literature? What are the competing theories for explanation of this question? How is this study different from prior research on this problem/question?

2. Research Design

Intervention(s)

- What type of an intervention does the study involve¹? Elaborate in detail when, where and by whom it will be delivered. Please provide sufficient detail to allow for replication in line with this journal's [Mandatory Replication Policy](#).
- How will individual observations be assigned to treatment and control conditions²?
- Are there multiple treatment arms involved and if so, are they exclusive or overlapping?
- What is the source of exogenous variation in your study?
- If applicable, what observations will be blinded (masked)³ after assignment to interventions and how? If blinding is not possible, what measures will be taken to minimize the potential for performance and expectancy biases (e.g. keeping participants unaware of trial hypotheses, measuring participant and provider expectations of benefit at baseline, etc.)?
- The instructions and supporting materials for the administration of the intervention should be included as an appendix.

Hypotheses

- What are the main outcomes of interest? Which outcomes are primary to the analysis, which are secondary, and why?
- How will the main outcomes of interest be defined in your dataset?

¹ For more information on reporting standards for interventions, see Hoffmann et al. (2014).

² For more information on what to report on randomization, see Bruhn and McKenzie (2009).

³ Blinding or masking refers to methods of withholding information about assigned interventions post-randomization from those involved in the trial, when knowledge of this information could influence their behavior in a way that would later prove integral to interpreting the results (Grant 2017, 12)

- Please include all hypotheses which will be tested, linking each outcome specifically to how it will be measured. These should be reported as main results in the Stage 2 submission.

Basic methodological framework / Identification strategy

- What is the basic methodological framework of the study (RCT, pre-post, simple comparison, difference-in-difference etc.) and why is it suitable to address this research question?

Data

Please use this section to provide details on pilot data and *prospective* data that you will collect after pre-results acceptance of your research design.

Sample

- What is the unit of analysis for this sample (individuals, organizations, etc.)?
- What is the expected sample size? If applicable, please include statistical power calculations⁴ to justify sample size.
- What is the effect size you will be able to detect?

Data collection and processing

- What are the key data sources? What data collection procedures and instruments will be used?
- What is the rule for terminating data collection (number of observations, available funds, available time, etc.)?
- How long will the data collection process take? If data will be collected at multiple points (longitudinal design), what is the proposed schedule (including enrollment, intervention delivery and outcome assessment)?
- What measures will you take to ensure data quality in terms of accuracy, consistency, bias, and completeness (e.g. double entry if manual entry of handwritten forms, audits of survey work, etc.)?

Variations from the intended sample size

- Do you anticipate any challenges in collecting data (attrition, non-compliance with the assigned treatment, etc.) and what measures do you plan to take to prevent them?

Pilot data

- Summarize any pilot data used in preparation for this submission. These can be included to establish reality checks, effect size estimations, feasibility, or proof of principle.

⁴ Useful information and software tools for power calculations can be found [here](#).

3. Empirical Analysis

Please use this section to present your strategy for statistical analysis. In the appendices section of this submission, please also include any computer programs, configuration files, or scripts which will be used to run the experiment and to analyze the data.

Statistical methods

- What statistical methods will be used to analyze the data and what are their underlying assumptions?
- How will the study deal with missing values?
- How do you define and handle outliers?

Statistical model

Provide the model in its *functional* form and submit math equations as editable text and not as images.

Multiple outcome and multiple hypothesis testing

- How will the study address false positives from multiple hypothesis testing?
 - If you plan to adjust your standard errors, what adjustment procedure will you use? (e.g., Family Wise Error Rate, False Discovery Rates, etc.)
 - If you plan to aggregate multiple variables into an index, which variables will you aggregate and how?

Heterogeneous Effects

- Which groups do you anticipate will display heterogeneous effects? What leads you to anticipate these effects?

4. List of References

References can be in any style or format as long as the style is consistent.

5. Appendices

If there is more than one appendix, they should be identified as A, B, etc. Formulae and equations in appendices should be given separate numbering: Eq. (A.1), Eq. (A.2), etc.; in a subsequent appendix, Eq. (B.1) and so on. Similarly for tables and figures: Table A.1; Fig. A.1, etc.

6. Administrative information (*required*)

Funding: Please list funding sources in this standard way to facilitate compliance to funder's requirements:

(e.g. “This work was supported by the National Institutes of Health [grant numbers xxxx, yyyy]; the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation, Seattle, WA [grant number zzzz]; and the United States Institutes of Peace [grant number aaaa]”).

If no funding has been provided for the research, please include the following sentence: “This research did not receive any specific grant from funding agencies in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors.”

Elsevier has established a number of agreements with funding bodies which allow authors to comply with their funder's open access policies. Some funding bodies will reimburse the author for the Open Access Publication Fee. Details of existing agreements are available [here](#).

Institutional Review Board (ethics approval): If applicable, please include a statement confirming that all necessary ethics approvals are in place.

Declaration of interest: Please provide a statement on competing interests, even if you have no competing interests to declare.

Examples of potential conflicts of interest include employment, consultancies, stock ownership, honoraria, paid expert testimony, patent applications/registrations, and grants or other funding. If there are no conflicts of interest then please state 'none'. You can learn more about our policies on conflicts of interests [here](#).

Acknowledgments: Please list here individuals who provided help during the research, however are not considered authors (e.g., providing language help, writing assistance or proof reading the article, etc.).

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